A completed import. Zero contacts.

CASE STUDY 01 / TECHNICAL SUPPORT & ENGINEERING HANDOFF

Scenario: In a fictional B2B SaaS contact platform, a customer uploads a small CSV. The interface reports “Completed,” but no contacts appear. The case explores a subtle CSV encoding edge case and how support can handle it without assuming the cause.

Scope & honesty: This is an original simulation, not an incident from Growix or a real customer. The attached Python demonstration reproduces the CSV-header mismatch locally; product behavior and customer messages below are hypothetical.

01 / Customer-first response

> Hi Ana, thanks for flagging this. I can see why it would be confusing to get a completed message without seeing any contacts. I’d like to narrow down whether the records were rejected during validation or imported into a different list.
>
> Could you share the import job ID, approximate upload time (with timezone), the list/workspace you selected, and a screenshot of the import summary? Please avoid sending actual customer contact details. If the issue persists, I can guide you through a small test file with dummy data. I’ll keep you updated on what we find.

02 / Triage without assumptions

CHECK	WHY IT MATTERS
Correct workspace / filter	Rules out successful import to a different location.
Permissions and list access	Distinguishes visibility problems from ingestion problems.
Job ID, status and row counts	Checks whether “completed” means processed or accepted.
CSV headers / encoding	Tests a possible invisible UTF-8 BOM prefix.
Safe, one-row dummy retry	Minimizes exposure of customer data.

Decision rule: Resolve in Level 1 only if the customer confirms a safe workaround and the result is verified. Otherwise escalate with reproducible evidence and clear uncertainty.

Make the escalation actionable.

CASE STUDY 01 / INTERNAL LEVEL 2 HANDOFF

03 / Engineering escalation draft (Jira-style)

Summary: Import status may be misleading when a UTF-8 BOM prefixes a required CSV header.

Customer impact: In this simulated case, a user believes the import succeeded but sees zero records. This risks repeat uploads, duplicate attempts and declining trust.

Observed in local reproducer: A standard UTF-8 CSV produces the header email. The same row saved with a UTF-8 BOM produces \ufeffemail when read using Python’s utf-8 decoder; a simple required-header check therefore fails.

Not yet established: Whether the hypothetical product uses this parser, suppresses validation errors, or really reports success. The proposed root cause is a hypothesis until product logs and behavior confirm it.

Reproduction & test evidence

1. Run python3 reproduce.py from the included sample folder.

2. Compare import_standard.csv against import_bom.csv. They have identical logical records.

3. Observe standard CSV: missing=[]; valid=True. BOM CSV: missing=['email']; valid=False.

4. In the actual product, test both with a dummy contact, in a staging environment or with approved safeguards. Record job ID, response, accepted/rejected counts and logs.

Expected product behavior: Accept an optional BOM safely, or reject the file with a specific validation explanation. A “Completed” status must distinguish processed rows from successfully imported rows.

Proposed fix for investigation: Normalize optional BOM at ingestion (for example, utf-8-sig); add tests for UTF-8 with/without BOM and empty/error outcomes; expose accepted, rejected and skipped counts in UI.

Escalation checklist

Priority: assess by number of affected customers and blocked imports, not by guesswork. Attach sanitized one-row fixtures; redact emails, tokens and account identifiers. Assign to import/parser owner; request status copy and row-level error handling from product/UX if confirmed.

Follow-up: Tell the customer the next check and update when evidence changes; do not promise a repair timeline without engineering confirmation.

Turn one ticket into better support.

CASE STUDY 01 / KNOWLEDGE BASE + PREVENTION

04 / Draft help-centre article

Title: CSV import completed but no contacts appeared

First, check: Confirm the correct workspace, list and filters. Open the import summary and check the number of accepted, skipped and rejected rows if available.

Try a safe test: Export a copy of your CSV in UTF-8 format and retry with a single dummy contact and the exact expected column names, such as email and name. Keep your original file unchanged.

If it still fails: Contact support with the job ID, upload time and a screenshot of the summary. Do not send real contact data, passwords or API keys unless using an approved secure support channel.

What support will do: Review job status and validation feedback; investigate encoding and field mapping where relevant; escalate confirmed product issues with a sanitized reproducer.

05 / Reusable response macro

> “Thanks for reporting this. Could you confirm the workspace/list, the import job ID and whether the summary shows any rejected rows? We can safely test with a one-row dummy file. Please do not email a CSV containing customer details. I’ll help distinguish a file-format issue from a product issue and update you with what we find.”

06 / Prevent the next ten tickets

Product: Display ‘0 imported / 1 rejected’ rather than a generic ‘Completed’. Offer an actionable validation reason and allow users to download a sanitized error report.

Support: Add a CSV encoding/header check to the first-response checklist; tag repeat issues consistently; link the help-centre article in the import flow if confirmed.

Measure: Track repeat-contact rate, first-contact resolution, time to engineering reproduction and help-centre deflection for CSV import issues.

What this sample demonstrates

Customer empathy without blame, evidence-based troubleshooting, accurate uncertainty, clear Level 2 handoffs, data minimization, and closing the feedback loop.

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